

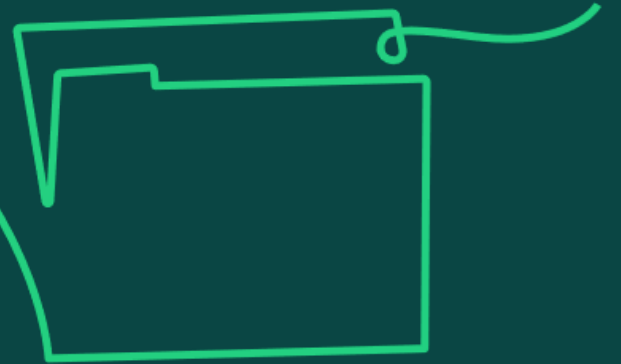
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Diversity and inclusion

Learning objective:

14. Diversity and inclusion: Understand diversity and inclusion as the ability to build and maintain an inclusive environment that embraces a diverse culture.

14a) Knowledge of diversity, including characteristics which may cause a person to be treated less favourably, such as: age, disability, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex, and sexual orientation.



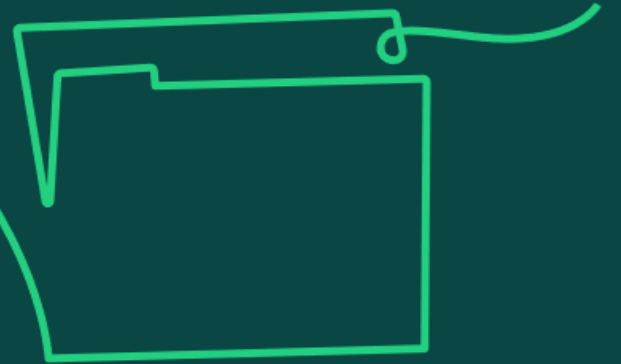
Diversity

- Diversity leads to higher performance through diverse skill sets and perspectives.
- This is of great value to projects and helps to enable successful delivery of outcomes.
- Project-based working is made up of teams with different backgrounds, experiences and capabilities which should be embraced.
- National cultures are developed over long periods of time and are influenced by different drivers, which in turn influence people's values and beliefs, and these shape people's behaviours.
- As part of stakeholder analysis, project professionals can research different cultures to understand typical behaviours.
- Value is created from difference.

Diversity

- In many countries, it is illegal to discriminate against people based on protected characteristics. It is important that project professionals, if unsure, seek advice on how to treat people fairly, particularly as protected characteristics can vary by country.
- Age,
- Disability,
- Marriage and civil partnership,
- Pregnancy and maternity,
- Race,
- Religion or belief,
- Sex, and sexual orientation,
- Gender.

14b) Understand why incorporating diversity into all parts of a project, from team members to customers, is a factor in creating a positive working environment and understand the importance of embracing diverse thinking in teams as a means of generating innovative solutions.



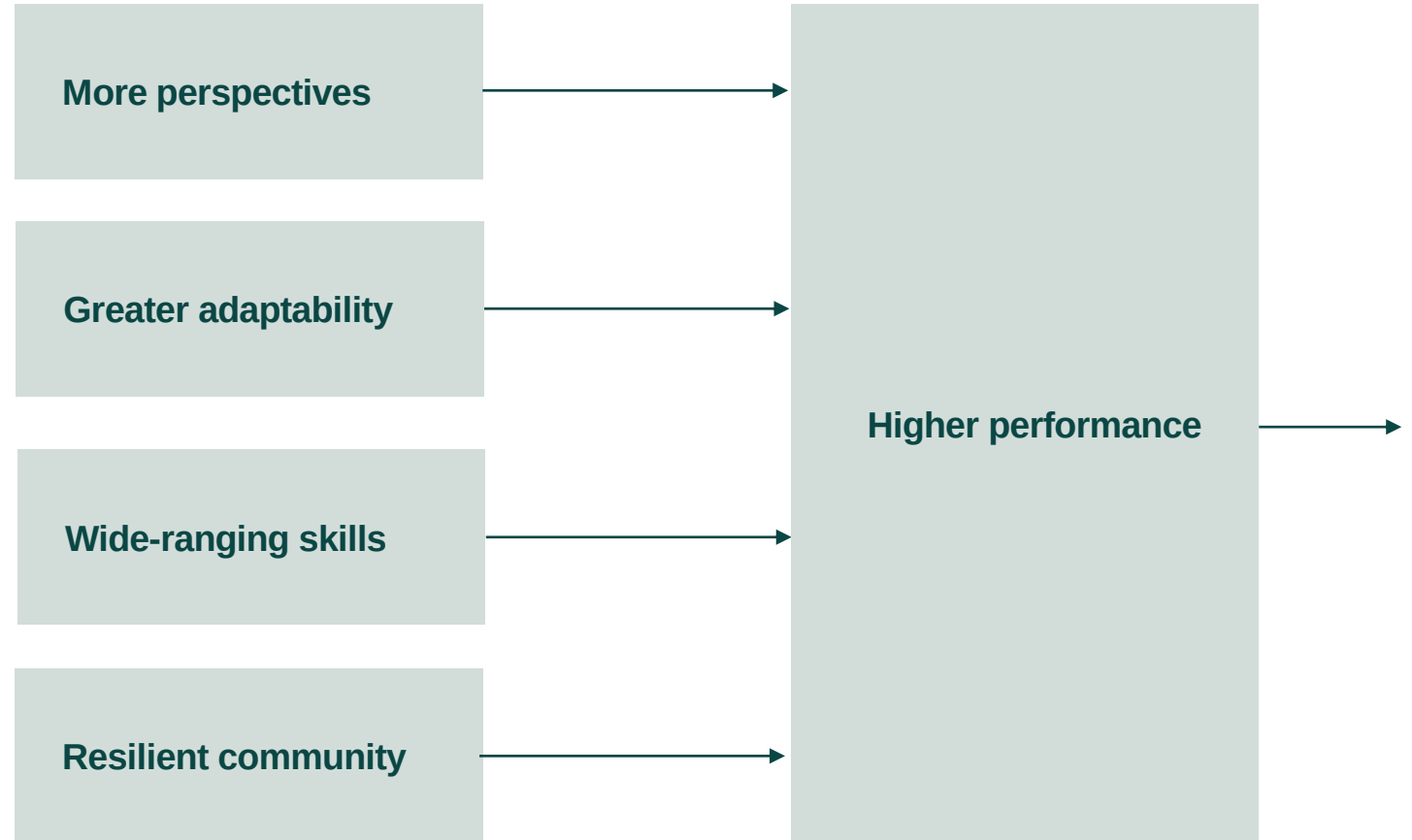
Diversity in project teams

- In project-based working, temporary teams come together and need to perform quickly.
- These teams can be based in the same office, in different countries or in different continents.
- Leadership and communication styles are enabling factors in maximising opportunities to create an open, honest and psychologically safe environment.
- The workplace environment needs to consider different individuals' perspectives, abilities and any reasonable adjustments required to form ways of working that enable a positive working environment and ensure everyone has a fair chance.

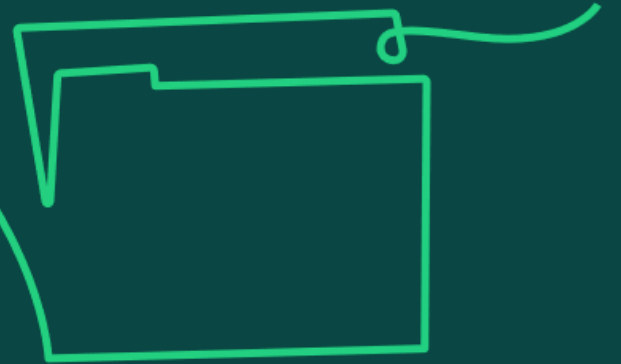
Diversity leads to higher performance

Consider:

- Do people feel they can be themselves at work?
- Are people encouraged to share ideas, and challenge respectfully?
- Do people understand and welcome differences?
- If we can answer yes, to the above, then we will benefit in the following ways:



14c) Understand how conscious and unconscious bias can affect actions and know how to treat people fairly, including adapting behaviours to support individuals' needs and facilitate their contributions.



Conscious and unconscious bias

- Human nature is to favour the norm 'like us' rather than 'different from' us: this leads to unconscious and conscious bias.
- Conscious and unconscious biases are ingrained preferences or prejudices that influence our perceptions and decision making.
- Conscious bias involves deliberate thoughts and attitudes, while unconscious bias operates involuntarily, often stemming from societal stereotypes.
- These biases can affect our understanding, actions and decisions in an implicit manner.
- A strong sense of inclusion and community is fostered when people with different backgrounds come together for a common purpose. Project professionals can improve outcomes by harnessing the diversity of people involved.

Improving performance

If individuals feel engaged and valued, there will be an improvement in team performance and solutions.

- Create and sustain a positive, inclusive working environment and address any potential barriers.
- Make reasonable adjustments to ensure that everyone has a fair chance.

- Manage differences to achieve a common purpose.
- Consider the contributions that can be made by individual team members.

- Think about ways to communicate in a meaningful way.
- Remember that multiple dimensions of culture exist.

- Balance priorities and actively accept the need to treat people fairly.
- Explore and respond to signs of bias.

- Lead by example: demonstrate appropriate behaviours and communication.
- Adapt to facilitate contributions from all team members.
- Recognise signs of resistance, either individually or organisationally, to inclusion and diversity.